There should be no need to get valuation verified by the departmental officers, except on the basis of scrutiny of only about 0.5 per cent of returns.

A small tax on the valuation gains made during the year on the total portfolio of assets should be imposed—say at the rate of 2 per cent assessed and payable every year. The government can also create a class of extraordinary or super valuation gains, say, exceeding Rs 10 crore in a year, which should be subjected to a higher wealth tax of 5 per cent on the valuation gains made over Rs 10 crore.

The tax on valuation gains so assessed can be paid either in cash or transferring a part of the financial asset.

Introduction of a New Pollution and Carbon Tax

The businesses create positive value added. They also contribute negative value added. All the pollutants, including carbon, emitted or discharged in the air, water and soil, affect the quality of air, water and soil and, in turn, the quality of life. Positive value added in goods and services contribute to the maintenance of humans and their quality of life, whereas the negative value added adversely impacts them and their quality of life.

Businesses have gotten away with discharging the pollutants, including carbon, imposing these costs on people and planet without being asked to pay for the same. The time has come to make the businesses internalize these costs. This can be done by imposing a new Pollution and Carbon Tax linked to the negative value added to the environment.

India's Efforts at Imposing Carbon Tax

Coal and other fossil fuels contribute considerable negative value added in the form of CO_2, NOx, SOx and other pollutants like mercury, etc. India imposed a cess on coal in the year 2010 as additional excise duty, which